

## film review

# No Fire

**RAM GOPAL VARMA KI AAG**

Director: Ram Gopal Varma

Starring: Amitabh Bachchan, Ajay Devgan, Sushmita Sen

In *Ram Gopal Varma ki Aag*, almost every other scene features a close-up of peculiar-looking men with bulging eyes and sinister faces. They're led by the ultimate baddie: Babban, the new millennium Gabbar Singh. Amitabh Bachchan, playing Babban, is mercurial, menacing,



**Devgan and Kothari** funny and sadistic. The actor is having the time of his life. But the rest of Varma's cast seems pained to the point of paralysis. Devgan, reprising Dharmendra's role, is miscast; Nisha Kothari re-playing Basanti snarls till it hurts; Sush-

mita Sen tries to bring gravitas but mostly weeps. Varma, who became a filmmaker after seeing *Sholay*, is singularly unable to reconstruct it for a new generation. Thirty-two years later, Ramesh Sippy's vision endures. **by Anupama Chopra**

## recommendations

# Earthy Paradise

**MUMBAI** Piramal Gallery, NCPA, organises a photography exhibition 'Paradise Less Travelled' by Hitesh Brahmabhatt. The images are of non-touristy and lesser known regions of Arunachal Pradesh, Meghalaya, interiors of Orissa and the ancient Silk Route through Kinnaur and Spiti in Himachal Pradesh. "Photography for me is an artistic pursuit with endless rewards. The creation of an image is always an exciting journey," says Brahmabhatt. As a regular traveller with a passion to explore the less frequented countryside, Brahmabhatt's goal is to give this momentary image its



### Exploring the unknown

own voice. Simultaneously, he is working on a theme-based collection, 'Shining Mumbai' where the city will play his muse and his focus will be on its changing faces. Till September 12.

**by Swati Mathur**

**DELHI** Mythologies Retold: *The Female Grail*, produced by Sandhya Raman and choreographed



**The female grail**

by Geeta Chandran is inspired by Jaya Appasamy's collection of paintings that celebrate female goddesses and their origins. At Kamani Auditorium on September 15.

**DELHI** Four theatre groups for children from Arunachal Pradesh, Meghalaya, Nagaland and Tripura will stage their plays in the first North-Eastern States Children's Theatre Festival.

The plays are directed by NSD's Adrija Dasgupta, K. Jugindro, Vijay Srivastava and Akhilesh Khanna. At Sri Ram Centre, September 9, 11, 13 and 15.

## music reviews

# Breaking Out

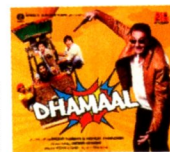


Big Music  
Price not mentioned

**WAQT PAR BOLNA**

When Hariharan started his career singing

ghazals, he was ridiculed. How could a south Indian singer sing ghazals, everyone scoffed. But Hariharan didn't give up. He bettered his Urdu diction and finally made it big. In this album he has tried to infuse Indian classical music with rhythm and blues. If the music has the inputs from sitar player Niladri Kumar or the flute by Ronu Majumdar, the album is sure to be a listener's delight. Melodious right down to the core. Go for it.



Sony-BMG  
Rs 175

**DHAMAAL**

Adnan Sami has tried his hand at music composition yet again,

with four songs that fail to live up to one's expectations fed by his earlier solo albums. The first number, *Dekho dekho dil ye bole: dhamaal runs out of steam after the chorus. The song Miss India martee mujh pe* by Sami and Amit Kumar is well orchestrated but only passable. Asha Bhosle in *Chandani raat hai saiyan* is different with the extensive use of harmonium. *Chan na che shor machlein* is nothing but cacophony.

**by S. Sahaya Ranjit**



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